



Debie Parvo camera
In 1908, 60 years after the earliest models, Frenchman Joseph Debie developed the "Le Parvo" camera. At one time it was the most used camera in the world.



Benz Velo
The Benz Velo of 1895 was the world's first standardized car. Powered by a single-cylinder engine, there were two forward speeds and no reverse gear.



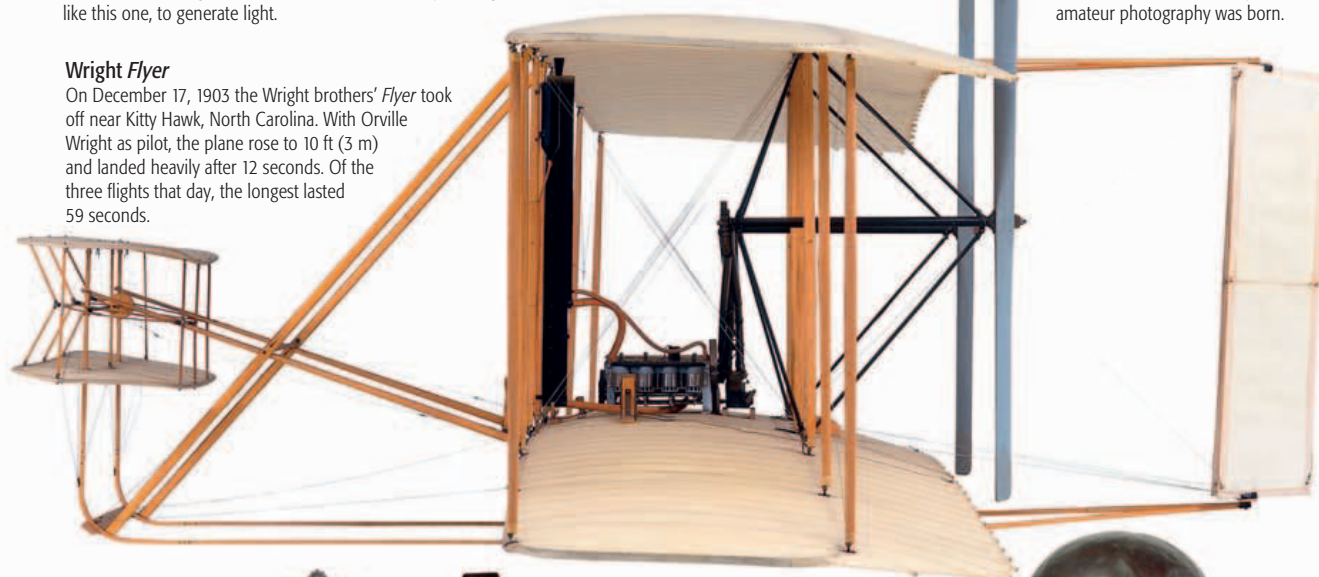
Carbon filament bulb
The carbon filament lamp of the 1870s used heated strips of carbon, housed in glass bulbs like this one, to generate light.



Remington No. 1 typewriter
The first popular typewriter was invented by the American Christopher Sholes in 1868. It was made by Remington, like this 1876 model.



Eastman Kodak Brownie
In the early 1900s the American George Eastman developed cheap cameras such as this example, and amateur photography was born.



Wright Flyer
On December 17, 1903 the Wright brothers' Flyer took off near Kitty Hawk, North Carolina. With Orville Wright as pilot, the plane rose to 10 ft (3 m) and landed heavily after 12 seconds. Of the three flights that day, the longest lasted 59 seconds.



Cash register
The American James Ritty invented the cash register in 1879 to stop theft by cashiers. The keys operated gears that added together the money paid in.



Leclanché cell
This late 19th-century Leclanché cell is an early example of a battery. Most batteries today are Leclanché cells encased in metal.

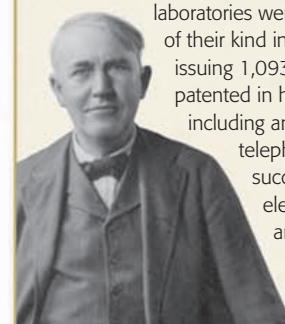


Diving helmet
This helmet is part of a watertight diving suit from 1839, which allowed the diver to operate at depths down to 300 ft (100 m).

AMERICAN INVENTOR (1847–1931)

THOMAS EDISON

Edison was a self-taught inventor. At the age of seven he set up his first chemistry laboratory at home. Attending school for only three months, from the age of 12 he began devoting all of his spare time to scientific experimentation. Edison's large-scale research



laboratories were the first of their kind in the world, issuing 1,093 devices patented in his name, including an improved telephone, a successful electric lamp, and the first movie projector.

AFTER

Science continued to progress in the 20th century, making technology accessible, and breaking down barriers to communication.

THE DAWN OF TELEVISION

In 1926 the Scottish engineer John Logie Baird transmitted pictures and words using radio waves 458–61 >>

PLASTICS

Domestic products were increasingly made of plastic 458–61 >> The first versatile domestic plastic was Bakelite, invented in 1909.

COMPUTER REVOLUTION

The first electronic computers were developed in secret in Britain and the United States during World War II. The miniaturization of computers by the use of silicon chips in the 1960s changed communication and industry 478–79 >>